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Summary

Former Site Reliability Engineer turned leader: the squishy human bits that use computers are fascinating, and org structures are the complex systems I focus on now. Start with empathy, move to understanding the problems, and focus on solutions that improve everyone's lives.

I especially love working at companies that are undergoing the growth transition from "Everything is great" to "Why are there so many communication problems now?".

Leadership

Loop Returns

Staff Site Reliability Engineer **January 2024 – August 2024**

As the first staff+ engineer outside of product engineering, began the process of defining a cohesive vision across the DevOps, DevEx, and Security teams.
Established lines of communication across to product engineering, settling several major bubbling issues.
Worked with a director to define the tech lead role, and mentored burgeoning tech leads both in a group setting as well as individually.

Example of work: When I arrived, the main burden of technical leadership had been resting on the other two staff engineers (no principal engineer or CTO). They had spent much time thoughtfully creating a technical vision for the company; the next struggle was in getting it implemented.
Upon investigation, the primary breakdown was in translating down to the next level of the company hierarchy: many of the TLs and EMs didn't know that translating this vision into actions for their team was their responsibility, and those that did largely struggled with prioritization and knowing *how* to do this. I pushed to restart a recurring meeting of technical leadership and change it from a round-robin recitation of what each team had done, and created a Slack channel as well for more off-the-cuff discussions. A recurring theme that appeared in those early meetings was "Ok, but how are we supposed to actually do that?".
Getting them talking to each other about this was an important step because it allowed them to trade ideas and spur each others' thought; long-term the goal was to have this be primarily self-sustaining.
In the meantime, I provided some targeted support to build momentum:

1. In group discussions, after giving space for others, giving advice on specific actions to prioritize projects (for instance, using Jira tagging and reports to keep track of manual work that could be eliminated through reduction of tech debt) - or sometimes just encouragement.
2. For leads who requested it, being present in discussions to help provide backup as someone with a staff title.
3. Every Friday, posting a link in the Slack channel to some bit of interesting leadership reading with how I had been thinking of applying it to my work, to remind folks to set aside time to step back from the onslaught of daily concerns.

A director outside my reporting chain had been working on defining the tech lead role, and so I also joined with them to get that finished and repeatedly inserted into our discussions with tech leads. My major contribution there was to genericize many of the concepts from applying only to product development and instead work also for my group (Platform), as well as the data engineering group (who didn't have a representative in the technical leadership groups).
Key technologies: AWS, ArgoCD, Terraform

Winnie

Staff Site Reliability Engineer **February 2022 – January 2024**

Role originator and owner of infrastructure, platform, pipeline, and security; defining vision and multi-year strategy and prioritizing backlog of tech debt.
Reported to the VP Eng and worked across all teams to identify duplicate work, address architectural problems, and build a collaborative culture of learning and improvement.
Member of eng managers meeting and substituted for a manager on parental leave.
Key technologies: AWS, Python, Pulumi, Github Actions

WePay (acquired by JPMorgan Chase)

Sr Staff Site Reliability Engineer **May 2021 – February 2022**

Identified and addressed org-wide technology, process, and people problems. Recognized common origins of different problems and extracted them into strategic projects. Sponsored under-leveled engineers. Served at the pleasure of the Senior Director of DevOps.
Owner of and interviewer trainer for SRE interview module. Active member of hiring committee, making leveling and hiring decisions for all of engineering.

Manager, Site Reliability Engineering **March 2020 – May 2021**

Provided a first line of time defense for the team. Worked with other engineering and product leads to plan and prioritize projects.

Key technologies: GCP, Kubernetes, Ansible, Sensu

Individual Contributor

WePay (acquired by JPMorgan Chase)

Senior Site Reliability Engineer **February 2017 – March 2020**

Embedded within an application team to provide a close reliability partner.
Key technologies: GCP, Kubernetes, Ansible, Sensu

Zoox

DevOps Engineer **December 2015 – February 2017**

Introduced operations practices and tools into a rapidly growing autonomous vehicle company. Worked on a wide range of tasks, including web development (Flask, Pyramid, custom C++, custom Python), build systems (Bazel), an in-house deploy application, operations for several dozen applications, network security, AWS user support, software documentation, and organization-wide standards.

reddit

Software Engineer **August 2014 – December 2015**

One of half a dozen engineers responsible for user-facing features on reddit.com, a site with over 200 million monthly active users. Fixed many bugs and annoyances that had been present for years. Built relationships with third-party add-on developers and community moderators. Implemented an A/B testing framework, a new comment sort and display algorithm, one of the most well-received features in site history (non-silent sidewide bans), and an expanded image preview system used by mobile web and third-party apps. Constantly refactored, documented, and added tests. Most work available for perusal at https://github.com/reddit-archive/reddit/commits?author=xiongchiamiov .

iFixit

Web Operations Lead Engineer **June 2012 – August 2014**
DevOps Engineering Intern **March 2011 – June 2012**

Implemented caching system that prevents previously-frequent media-induced downtimes. Implemented and championed application monitoring, leading to improvements in performance, stability, and user experience. Wrote alerting system that gives developers direct access to failure reports. Kickstarted thriving internal high-level documentation project. Improved startup time of application servers from 15 minutes with 25% failures to <5 minutes with no failures.

XYZ Textbooks

Web Programmer / Sysadmin **June 2008 – March 2011**

Designed and developed intranet organizational web tools using Symfony. Maintained colocated CentOS web server running Cherokee, Apache, Redmine. Modified open-source online homework systems (WeBWorK, IMathAS) and worked with developers to merge patches upstream.

Cal Poly

Web Developer **July 2008 – November 2008**

Developed new department websites using Django and PostgreSQL. Maintained legacy PHP+MySQL websites. Migrated content from legacy websites to new Django-based websites. Improved customer satisfaction by resolving old bugs and feature requests.

Education

California Polytechnic University, San Luis Obispo, California

B.S of Software Engineering

Skills / Keywords

Cloud Computing: Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP)
Containers: Kubernetes, Docker Desktop/Compose, Amazon ECS
Infrastructure as Code: Ansible, Pulumi, Terraform
CI/CD: Github Actions, ArgoCD, Teamcity, Jenkins
Linux: Red Hat family (CentOS), Arch Linux, Debian family (Ubuntu, Debian)
Monitoring/Alerting: Sensu, Graphite, StatsD, pipe-to-graphite, collectd
Scripting: Bash and utils (sed, awk, grep), Python, Ruby
Backend: Python (Django, Flask, Pyramid), PHP (Symfony, custom), Ruby (Sinatra)
Databases: MySQL, Redis, PostgreSQL, SQLite, DynamoDB, Cassandra
Web Application servers/proxies: Varnish, Apache, HAProxy, Nginx, Tomcat, uWSGI
Version control systems: Git, Mercurial, Subversion
Queueing/Messaging: Gearman, Kafka, RabbitMQ, beanstalkd